

SHARAD PAWAR

AGRICULTURE

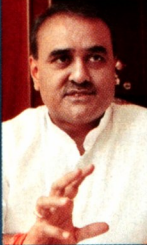


- Rs 500-crore grant for micro irrigation mission
- Rs 6,000-crore per annum subvention on crop loans
- Higher import duties on raw cotton and edible oils

“India needs to usher in its second green revolution. This will require affordable credit to farmers, investments and fiscal support.”

PRAFUL PATEL

CIVIL AVIATION



- Reduction of taxes on air turbine fuel from 20 per cent to 4 per cent
- Declared goods status to ATF
- A bailout package for national carrier Air India to lift it out of the financial crunch

“We have asked for help and the Government has promised to go the extra mile. Now employees of the national carrier must reciprocate with performance.”

ANAND SHARMA

COMMERCE

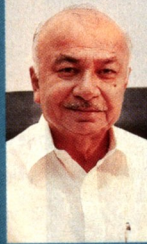


- Stimulus package for exporters
- Specific incentives for labour intensive textiles, leather sectors
- Abolition of Fringe Benefit Tax and Inverted Custom Duty

“We need to focus and help sectors like gems, textiles and leather so that we can create new job opportunities.”

SUSHIL KUMAR SHINDE

POWER



- Revised fund allocation of Rs 14,000 crore for rural electrification
- Enhanced budget for Accelerated Power Development Programme
- Extended 10-year tax exception for Independent Power Producers

“We have made a commitment to providing power for all. This needs fiscal incentives and large investments.”

MURLI DEORA

PETROLEUM



- Excise cut on petrol and diesel by Re 1 per litre
- Restore tax holiday on natural gas production
- Declared goods status to natural gas

“The seven-year tax holiday from payment of income-tax under NELP should also apply to natural gas as is available on crude oil production.”

DAYANIDHI MARAN

TEXTILES



- Fiscal relief, including service tax exemption, to textile exporters
- Faster clearance of arrears of terminal excise duties, CST
- A national fibre policy to unify different tax structures for different fibres

“Textiles is the second largest employer after agriculture, accounting for 4 per cent of the GDP. With support, textiles could be the new sunrise sector.”

taking the aviation sector places. Now struggling with the loss-ridden Air India, he would not mind a bailout package for the airlines. According to Patel, the airlines has made a loss of Rs 2,156 crore for 2008-09. Steep increase in prices of fuel in the first half of the year and drop in passenger traffic have thrown the airlines into a deep credit crunch. Total sector losses for the fiscal year ended in March 2009 are expected to nearly double from last year to \$1.75 billion. Patel may be looking at reduction of taxes on jet turbine fuel from 20 per cent to 4 per cent and giving declared goods status to ATF which is currently 40 per cent of the operating cost of an airline.

Maratha strongman Sharad Pawar may not have made the second green revolution a reality yet, but he is on track. A Rs 500-crore grant for micro-irrigation mission and Rs 6,000 crore per annum subvention on crop loans are his demands to that order. He also wants a 20 per cent increase in the import duty for crude oil, 27.5 per cent hike for refined edible oils and restoration of the import duty of 10 per cent on raw cotton. Augmenting the rural thrust is a Rural Development Ministry proposal to expand the NREGA from 100 days' employment for two persons in a household to 200 days. Earlier, the stimulus was for the corporate sector, points out S. Mahendra Dev, chairman, Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices. “Now with inclusive growth becoming the buzzword, the focus has shifted to the unorganised sector which contributes 20 per cent to the output. The demands if met could translate into spending of Rs 30,000 crore,” says Dev.

Minister for Commerce and Industry Anand Sharma believes the downtrend in exports can be reversed by a stimulus package for the exporters. He is pitching for sector-specific incentives for labour-intensive manufacturing units like handlooms, textiles, leather, gems and jewellery, hit badly by shrinking overseas demand and job loss. According to Ajai Sahai, director-general of the Federation of Indian